



DOST GATES Program & JICA DXLab Collaboration Communications and Coordination Plan

I. PURPOSE

This document establishes the communication and coordination arrangements that will guide the implementation of the technical collaboration between the DOST Geospatial Analytics and Technology Solutions (GATES) Program and the Japan International Cooperation Agency Digital Transformation Lab (JICA DXLab).

The Plan aims to ensure that collaboration activities remain coordinated, transparent, and aligned with the objectives, priorities, and governance structure of the GATES Program. It also seeks to maintain program-level oversight, support effective knowledge exchange, and prevent fragmented engagements across component projects.

This document is intended to serve as a reference for coordinating activities, engagements, discussions, recommendations, and outputs arising from the collaboration.

II. CORE GUIDING PRINCIPLES

As an R&D-driven initiative, GATES is mandated to undertake research, development, integration, implementation, and institutionalization activities across data governance, enterprise architecture, data platforms, AI/ML capabilities, geospatial analytics, use case development, interoperability, and program sustainability in accordance with DOST's operational, technical, and institutional requirements. The program is therefore intended to strengthen long-term institutional capability, technical self-reliance, and sustainable platform ownership within DOST.

In this regard, JICA DX Lab is recognized as a valued strategic partner whose engagement can help inform, enrich, and strengthen the ongoing design and implementation efforts of GATES through technical advisory support, knowledge exchange, and capability augmentation.

To help ensure alignment of the proposed engagement with the mandate, implementation approach, and long-term strategic direction of the GATES Program, the following guiding principles are emphasized:

- **Alignment with Existing GATES Direction and Governance**

The GATES Program is currently being implemented through multiple interconnected component projects with corresponding technical, operational, and institutional workstreams already underway. As such, any proposed collaboration activities need to be positioned in a manner that complements and strengthens the existing program roadmap, governance mechanisms, and implementation structure already established within DOST.

In this regard, DOST shall continue to retain full authority and decision-making over program direction, prioritization, implementation sequencing, architecture evolution, governance arrangements, and adoption of proposed outputs and recommendations.

- **Nature of Technical Assistance and Recommendations**

Given the strategic and evolving nature of the GATES initiative, we view the proposed engagement primarily as a strategic technical advisory and capability augmentation collaboration. Recommendations, assessments, frameworks, and reference designs generated during the engagement may therefore serve as advisory inputs for consideration by DOST and the GATES Program.

Considering the broader institutional, operational, technical, and inter-agency dimensions of GATES, implementation decisions may require further validation, contextualization, prioritization, and alignment with ongoing activities across the different component projects and participating agencies.

- **Institutional Sustainability and Capability Development**

DOST highly values approaches that strengthen long-term institutional sustainability and internal technical capability. In this regard, we hope that the engagement places strong emphasis on knowledge transfer, documentation, capability strengthening, mentoring, and operational sustainability to ensure that the continued evolution and implementation of GATES remains institutionally driven and sustainable independent of external technical assistance arrangements.

Relatedly, DOST also recognizes the importance of maintaining flexibility in the selection, adaptation, and evolution of technologies, methodologies, standards, and implementation approaches in consideration of operational requirements, government processes, infrastructure realities, and long-term maintainability.

- **Intellectual Property, Data Governance, and Use of Outputs**

Considering the strategic and national-level nature of the GATES Program, DOST likewise recognizes the importance of ensuring appropriate protection and stewardship of program-related intellectual property, technical outputs, institutional knowledge products, datasets, frameworks, and implementation artifacts developed or refined through the engagement.

In this regard, any outputs generated specifically for the GATES Program must remain fully usable, extensible, and operationally accessible to DOST for future enhancement, institutionalization, scaling, and operational deployment.

III. COMMUNICATIONS GOVERNANCE STRUCTURE

ROLES	RESPONSIBILITIES
GATES Program Leader	Provides overall strategic direction and oversight of the GATES collaboration.
GATES Program Manager - Collaboration Lead	Provides overall oversight, direction, coordination, monitoring, and documentation of collaboration activities. Serves as the primary coordination point for the collaboration with the JICA.
GATES Project Leaders	Provide project-level oversight and guidance and ensure that collaboration activities remain aligned with project objectives, deliverables, and implementation plans.
Technology Workstream Lead	Coordinates discussions, activities, and technical inputs related to data architecture, data governance, data quality, production environment, and AI policy and architecture, among others, while ensuring alignment with GATES Program plans, priorities, and governance mechanisms.
Business Workstream Lead	Coordinates discussions, activities, and technical inputs related to use cases and applications, while ensuring alignment with GATES Program plans, priorities, and governance mechanisms.
Workstream Members	Participate in collaboration activities; provide technical, operational, and subject matter inputs; review recommendations and outputs; support documentation requirements; and coordinate with their respective Workstream Leads on matters related to the collaboration.
JICA DXLab Team	Serves as the institutional partner of the GATES Program and provides overall technical advisory support, strategic guidance, and knowledge exchange.
Boston Consulting Group (BCG) Team	As JICA DXLab's consulting partner for the engagement, BCG provides project management support, facilitates technical discussions and workshops, develops technical recommendations and outputs, and supports day-to-day implementation of collaboration activities.
Office of the Assistant Secretary for Development Cooperation	Oversees institutional arrangements and high-level coordination related to the collaboration and supports alignment with broader DOST priorities and partnerships.

DOST GATES Program Management Team

Rodolfo J. Calzado, Jr. Assistant Secretary for Development Cooperation GATES Program Leader Engr. Mylene V. Jerez Assistant Scientist GATES Program Manager			
GATES Project Leaders:			
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DOST GATES & JICA DXLab Program Technical Collaboration Implementation Team

Role	Name	Contact Details
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Business Workstream (Use Case & Application)		
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IV. Communication and Coordination Protocols

1. **Program-Level Coordination.** All activities conducted under the collaboration shall be coordinated through the GATES Program. The official GATES Program email address (dostgates@dost.gov.ph) shall be copied in all formal communications, meeting invitations, requests, submissions, and documentation related to the collaboration.
2. **Requests and Engagements.** Requests from JICA DXLab and/or BCG related to collaboration activities shall be communicated through the Collaboration Lead/GATES Program Management Unit (PMU).

Upon receipt of a request, the Collaboration Lead/GATES PMU shall identify the appropriate workstream and coordinate with the relevant Workstream Lead. The Workstream Lead shall then coordinate with concerned workstream members.

3. **Coordination with JICA DXLab and BCG.** Strategic, program-level, governance, policy, architecture, prioritization, institutionalization, and implementation decisions shall be coordinated through the Collaboration Lead and, when necessary, elevated to the Program Leader.

For day-to-day implementation activities, technical discussions, workshops, consultations, data-related discussions, use case development activities, and other operational matters, Workstream Leads and designated workstream members may directly coordinate with JICA DXLab and/or BCG, as necessary.

The Collaboration Lead/GATES PMU shall be kept informed of such engagements. Matters affecting program direction, schedules, deliverables, commitments, resource requirements, risks, or decisions requiring program-level approval shall be elevated to the Collaboration Lead for appropriate action.

4. **Communication Across Workstreams.** Concerns, requests, and technical matters requiring coordination between workstreams shall be coursed through the respective Workstream Leads to ensure alignment. Workstream members may coordinate directly with members of another workstream for operational purposes, provided that their respective Workstream Leads are kept informed, as appropriate.
5. **Capacity Building Activities.** All training sessions, workshops, learning exchanges, mentoring activities, and capacity-building engagements conducted under the collaboration shall be coordinated through the GATES Program.
6. **Documentation and Reporting.** Key recommendations, agreements, action items, decisions, and next steps arising from collaboration activities within each workstream shall be documented and shared with relevant stakeholders and the Collaboration Lead/GATES PMU for monitoring, consolidation, and follow-through.

V. Regular Coordination Meeting

To support effective coordination, monitoring, and information sharing throughout the engagement period, the following coordination meetings shall be conducted:

1. **Weekly Technical Team Check-ins** - A one-hour meeting conducted in a hybrid format (online and/or in-person) involving members of the implementation team. The meeting shall serve as a venue to discuss progress, ongoing activities, issues, upcoming requirements, and action items.

Schedule: Every Wednesday, between 10:00 AM to 2:00 PM, subject to adjustments as necessary

2. **Monthly Program Leadership Meetings** - A monthly meeting involving the GATES Program Management and the Implementation Team. The meeting shall serve as a venue to provide updates on collaboration activities, discuss key recommendations and strategic considerations, address issues requiring management attention, and ensure alignment with GATES Program priorities and governance arrangements.

Schedule: Every last Tuesday of the month, between 10:00 AM to 12:00 NN, subject to adjustments as necessary